St. Philomena's College (Autonomous), Mysuru

Proceedings of the UGC sponsored One Day National Seminar on "Benchmarking Teaching Best Practices in Journalism in the Changed ICT Scenario" held on March 26, 2015

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Foreword



St. Philomena's College has a rich past on which we are striving to build a meaningful future. It is a Pilgrim Centre where seekers of knowledge and human development from various parts of world flock and find fulfilment. Every individual who spends time in this campus contributes his/her mite. What makes this institution to be recognized as a 'College of excellence' is very much evident. We visualize the possibilities of change, create the change and materialize the same. This is accomplished with social, national and global perspective in our endeavours and with an integrated approach. Our curriculum is designed and realized in the classrooms and in the campus to achieve the wholeness of an individual. The Inter-Religious Dialogue classes for the final year students as well as the foundation courses like Life Skills,during the first two years are coordinated and conducted by faculty who are competent in the field and help in realizing the Vision and Mission of the institution.

This One Day National Seminar on "Benchmarking Teaching Best Practices in Journalism in the Changed ICT Scenario" is just one among many efforts in imparting knowledge. I am happy that the department of Communication and Journalism is organizing the seminar which includes the keynote address and papers prepared by the participants. The deliberations during the conference will bring about greater awareness among all the participants with regard to teaching practices. I express my appreciation and gratitude to the Organizing Committee, members of staff and students as well as all those who have contributed in some way in organizing this National seminar.

Wishing you All the best.

Rev. Fr. LESLIE MORAS

Principal
St. Philomena's College, Mysuru

Seminar on 'Benchmarking Teaching Best Practices in Journalism' held



The Seminar was inaugurated by ***Vijay Grover,*** *Editor (South) of Tehelka while* ***Rev. Fr. Leslie Moras,*** *Principal of the college, presided over the programme*

A one day seminar on the topic 'Benchmarking Teaching Best Practices in Journalism in the changed ICT scenario' was inaugurated by **Vijay Grover,** Editor (South) of *Tehelka*while **Rev. Fr. Leslie Moras,** Principal of the college, presided over the programme.

Dr. N. Usha Rani, Professor, DoS, MCJ, University of Mysore, was the guest.

There were three panel sessions. The first session was on the topic 'Need for innovation in media education,' for which the panellists were **Dr. A.S. Chandra Mouli,** former Deputy Director, Door Darshan, **Dr. Usha Rani,** Professor, DoS, MCJ, UoM and **Laiqh Khan,** Journalist, The Hindu, Mysuru.

Dr. Chandra Mouli, in his address spoke about feature writing, documentaries, editing, content writing, broadcasting, script writing, production and directing.



He called upon the journalism students to be honest and stay updated with what is happening around the world. He noted that Journalism students should spend more time in studios, internship and field visits. He ruled that most of the Journalism students attend internship just for the sake of getting training certificates. Sharing his experience of working for Door Darshan, he felt happy that hundreds of TV channels have mushroomed in India these days.

Dr. Usha Rani, in her address, called upon the teachers of journalism to identify the skills in their students and guide them accordingly. She even urged them to make students become well versed in writing skills. Students have to Practice and practice and practice. Students can prepare themselves better for job opportunities after their course and can be confident only if they can communicate their ideas effectively and precisely in the business and academic worlds.

Laiqh Khan in his address, said, "An editor gives life to a news story."

He called upon the upcoming journalists to purchase professional cameras to click pictures instead of clicking pictures on their mobile phones.

He urged the upcoming journalists to be honest, inquisitive, curious and to develop their skills on a regular basis.

The second session was on the topic 'Bridging the Gap Between Theory and Practice in Journalism, 'for which the panelists were **VasantiHariprakash,** Freelance Journalist and Documentary Anchor; **Rajashekhar,** Chief of News Bureau, *The New Indian Express*, Bengaluru. There is a substantial gap between the transition from university to the workplace. The goal of university should be to properly equip students with relevant theory in their chosen field as well as the skills and practice to enable them to appropriately adapt and perform when they enter the workplace. Currently there is quite a strong general consensus that the gap not only exists and is pressing but is also increasing.

Both of them spoke about the challenges faced by the Journalism educators, especially when they do not have any experience from the field. Students are taught Journalism within the four walls of the classrooms and do not get any real life exposure. “The colleges offering Journalism education also are lacking the basic facility, for e.g., TV studios, Cameras, Computer Lab, Printing aids, etc”, they said.

The third session was on the topic 'Use of ICT in Media Education,' for which the panellists were **Dr. Mahesh Chandraguru,** Professor, Department of Mass Communication and Journalism, University of Mysore. He said it is very important that the Journalism students should get an exposure to the professional life of Media. The questions posed by the students on how the

theories studied in class apply in real life. The gap between the ‘textbook’ journalism education and ‘on-the-ground’ reporting has to be bridged. The traditional journalism education is “highly theoretical” and it leaves gaps in skill and knowledge perception. There is an important shift in that perception working **in** the industry. There should be a break from the media theory-centric courses. Academics are often ignorant of the requirement of the media. Journalists need to be exceptionally careful on matters such as this. ‘Stepping on toes’ should be the mantra. Additionally, budding journalists need to be educated and ‘in-the-know’ on topics and issues across a wide spectrum. A budding journalist should be techno savvy. He got to be aware of his own strengths and weaknesses. A journalist should possess exhaustive knowledge of Information and Communication Technology field.

Dr. Usha Rani, Department of Studies Mass Communication and Journalism, University of Mysore.

Valedictory

The valedictory was held in the evening. **Prof. M. KrishneGowda,** Head, Department of Kannada, St. Philomena's College was the chief guest. Addressing the gathering he said Great teachers are earnest learners. Students of today are better teachers especially in Information and communication Technology.

Teachers need to frequently step offstage and facilitate entire class discussion. This allows students to learn from each other. It's also a great opportunity for teachers to formatively assess (through observation) how well students are grasping new content and concepts.

Rev. Fr. Leslie Moras, Principal presided over the function. Discussing the role a teacher has to play, he opinedWhen a teacher begins a new chapter in the class, he should clarify the purpose and learning goals, and provide explicit criteria on how students can be successful. It's ideal to also present models or examples to students so they can see what the end product looks like.Smart classrooms with Projectors are the part of every institution. Every teacher has to learn the usage of the same.

Rev. Fr. Bernard Prakash, Vice-Principal, was present.





Laiqh Khan has been a journalist for more than 21 years in leading English language dailies like The Hindu and Deccan Herald, covering a wide range of beats from court, crime, civic issues, education, secretariat, politics, elections, information technology, telecommunication etc.

Currently, working as a City Editor for The Hindu in Bangalore. Passionate about digital journalism and social media. Ensuring daily news developments across city beats like crime, court, civic bodies, power, transport, health and education are not only broken on newspaper's Internet edition and shared on social media, but also well covered, crisply written and attractively displayed with photographs and info-graphics in the daily newspaper.